

feature entirely, because the same effect can be obtained by cropping the picture on a computer. If you do not have digital zoom, zoom in only to the limits of the optical zoom. This is because the digital zoom throws up an image of a lower quality. Some cameras with a digital zoom have a feature that does not reduce the quality, but saves a smaller size version of the image. This is great as it saves on precious memory space as well. However, in general, using digital zoom is not advisable.

5.3 Portraits

Clicking portraits is one of the most rewarding aspects of photography. There are no rules here, but some essentials. It's important to make sure that the face is getting plenty of light. There are elementary mistakes that are made on outings, where many pictures end up with the face in shadows simply because the photographer did not ask the person involved to take off a cap. Whether or not the person is looking at the camera, make sure that the eyes stand out, and some light is reflected off them. Instead of taking the camera closer to the person, stand back and zoom in. This makes sure that features such as the nose and the eyes are not exaggerated.

The portrait mode in your camera blurs the background, but keeps the subject in focus. This draws attention to the person, but capturing the background is a good idea in some circumstances, especially if it adds some personality to the portrait. If you are taking portraits for print, make sure to have a healthy amount of background. If however, the portrait is for sharing over the web, fill the frame with the face.

A portrait is not necessarily just the face from the front. Diagonal frames capture movement, vertical frames capture rigidity and firmness, whereas horizontal frames capture tranquillity and peace. Use these appropriately when taking portraits. For example, diagonal frames work great with people in movement or in some vigorous physical activity. Don't overuse this approach though. People sleeping, eating, or indulging in some activity that involves only the upper body go well with horizontal frames. Close ups of the face work well with vertical frames. These are, however, just general guidelines. Experiment heavily with framing, capture only a fraction of the face, use